

# blkdiag

Block diagonal matrix

## Syntax

```
B = blkdiag(A1,...,AN)
```

## Description

B = blkdiag(A1,...,AN) returns the [block diagonal matrix](#) created by aligning the input matrices A1,...,AN along the diagonal of B. [example](#)

## Examples

[collapse all](#)

### Diagonal of Three Matrices

Create a block diagonal matrix from three matrices of different sizes.

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```
A1 = ones(2,2);
A2 = 2*ones(3,2);
A3 = 3*ones(2,3);
B = blkdiag(A1,A2,A3)
```

[Get](#) ▼

B = 7×7

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| 0 | 0 | 2 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| 0 | 0 | 2 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| 0 | 0 | 2 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 3 | 3 |
| 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 3 | 3 |

## Input Arguments

[collapse all](#)

A1,...,AN — Input matrices  
matrices

Input matrices, specified as a comma-separated list of matrices. The matrices can be either square or rectangular and can differ in size.

If any of the input matrices are sparse, then the output block diagonal matrix is also sparse.

## More About

[collapse all](#)

### Block Diagonal Matrix

A block diagonal matrix is a matrix whose diagonal contains blocks of smaller matrices, in contrast to a regular diagonal matrix with single elements along the diagonal. A block diagonal matrix takes on the following form, where  $A1, A2, \dots, AN$  are each matrices that can differ in size:

$$\begin{bmatrix} A1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & A2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \ddots & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & AN \end{bmatrix}$$

## Extended Capabilities

[collapse all](#)

### C/C++ Code Generation

Generate C and C++ code using MATLAB® Coder™.

### GPU Code Generation

Generate CUDA® code for NVIDIA® GPUs using GPU Coder™.

### Thread-Based Environment

Run code in the background using MATLAB® backgroundPool or accelerate code with Parallel Computing Toolbox™ ThreadPool.

The blkdiag function fully supports thread-based environments. For more information, see [Run MATLAB Functions in Thread-Based Environment](#).

### GPU Arrays

Accelerate code by running on a graphics processing unit (GPU) using Parallel Computing Toolbox™.

The blkdiag function fully supports GPU arrays. To run the function on a GPU, specify the input data as a [gpuArray](#) (Parallel Computing Toolbox). For more information, see [Run MATLAB Functions on a GPU](#) (Parallel Computing Toolbox).

### Distributed Arrays

Partition large arrays across the combined memory of your cluster using Parallel Computing Toolbox™. (since R2024b)

The blkdiag function fully supports distributed arrays. For more information, see [Run MATLAB Functions with Distributed Arrays](#) (Parallel Computing Toolbox).

## Version History

### Introduced before R2006a

## See Also

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[diag](#)

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